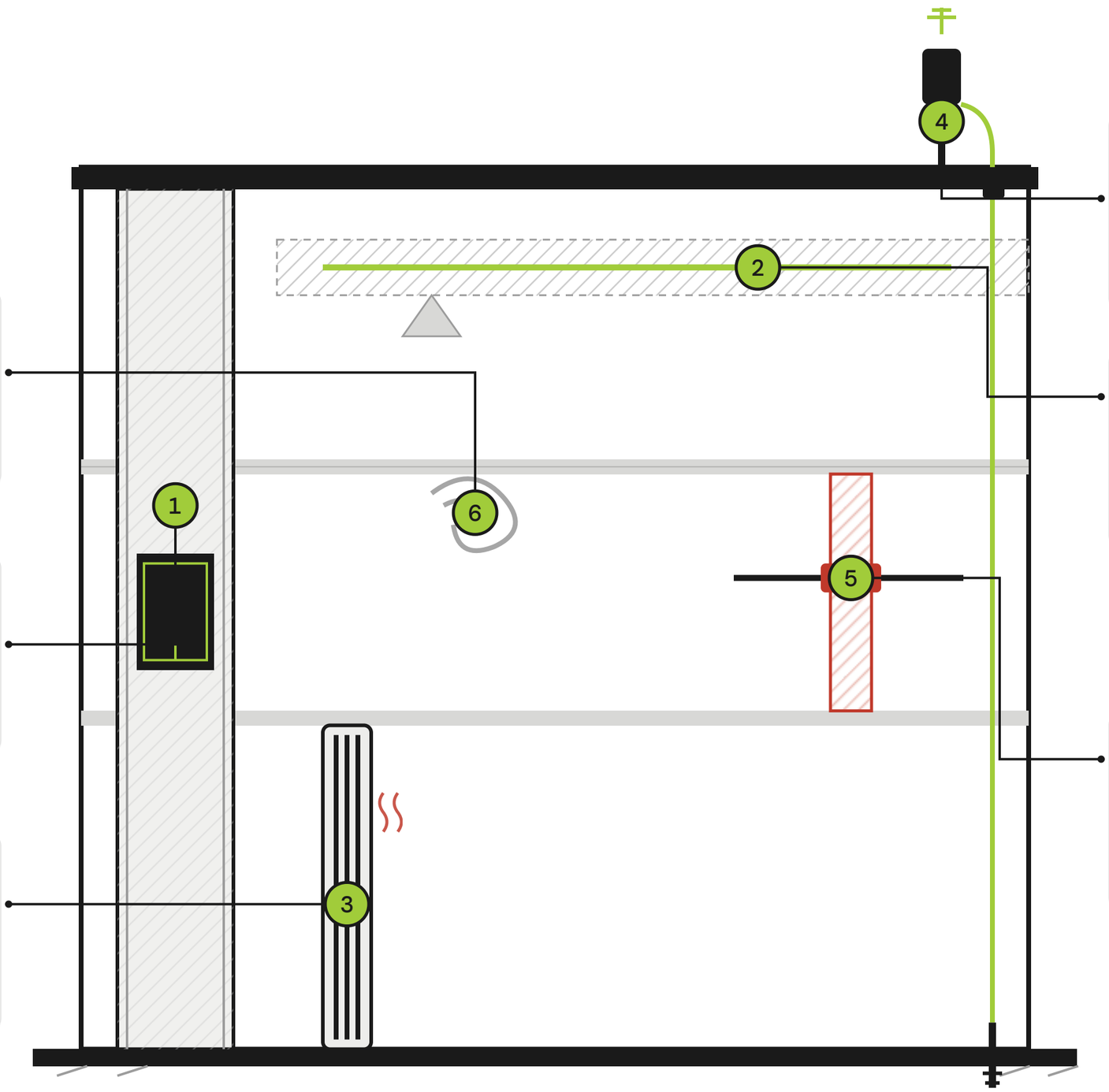
FIELD & TRADE REFERENCE

NEC Gotchas on a WLAN Job

Six National Electrical Code articles that bite an installer - pinned to where they live in the building. Recognize each one, then defer to the AHJ, a licensed electrician, or the equipment listing.



6 Art. 800.25

Abandoned cable

Accessible cable not terminated and not tagged for future use **must be removed**. Decades of dead cable is a fuel load. On a refresh you own pulling the old runs, not just adding new.

1 Art. 620.37

Elevator hoistway - no AP

Only elevator equipment may occupy the shaft. A coverage AP is not elevator gear, so it **cannot go in the hoistway**. Cover the car from the adjacent lobby, or use the elevator vendor's in-car system.

3 Art. 725.144

PoE bundle heat

Power + data heats the copper; cables in the center of a fat bundle can't shed it. Matters for 60 W (Type 3) and ~90 W (Type 4) APs. **Watch tight bundles in conduit at high ambient.**

4 Art. 810

Antenna grounding & bonding

Outdoor antennas and masts must be grounded and bonded (810.21) with a listed discharge unit near the entry (810.20). It mitigates nearby strikes and static - **nothing survives a direct hit.**

2 Art. 300.22

Plenum ceiling - CMP cable

Where the ceiling void moves HVAC air, cable must be plenum-rated **Type CMP** and the AP listed for plenum use. A dropped ceiling is not automatically a plenum.

5 Art. 300.21

Firestop at penetrations

Cable through a fire-rated wall or floor must be **fire-stopped with a listed system** to restore the rating. Recognize the rated wall; the method is a listed assembly + AHJ matter, never improvised.

CABLE FIRE-RATING LADDER · ART. 800 — **CMP** plenum > **CMR** riser > **CM / CMG** general > **CMX** dwelling

Substitution runs **downhill only** - CMP replaces CMR anywhere, but **CMR cannot be used in a plenum**. (It is a jacket fire-rating, not a data-performance spec.)

Reference only - recognize it, then defer. NEC adoption, amendments, and exact article boundaries vary by jurisdiction and code cycle. Confirm every install against the currently adopted NEC, the equipment listing, the building code, and the Authority Having Jurisdiction (AHJ).